ROWANTREE GROCERY COOPERATIVE

Rowantree Grocery Cooperative | proposed service provider

A controlled market-entry pilot for Netherfield Industries

A six-week, California-first services pilot designed to test execution quality and distribution retention before any wider commitment.

The candid starting point

Our coverage is thin in Nevada and Arizona. Our last two brand launches lost distribution within a year. This proposal does not explain away either fact or promise an outcome.

Prepared for Juno Blackwood, Founder | Discussion draft for Tanneryside Advisory clearance by 21 March 2025, 5:00 p.m.

The decision is a test, not a leap

Founder outcome: decide whether Rowantree can earn a broader role through observable, governed execution.

Authorize now

Authorize a defined six-week California-first pilot planning phase. No retailer, slotting, or trade-spend commitment is authorized by this decision.

Learn during pilot

Test approved scope, readiness, field verification, early velocity signals, and the percentage of activated doors retained at each review point.

Decide at gates

Continue, adjust, or stop using pre-agreed thresholds. Nevada and Arizona remain excluded unless coverage is separately verified and approved in writing.

What Rowantree is proposing

Not freight with nicer slides: a launch operating loop that coordinates retailer requirements and authorized slotting opportunities, uses category evidence to recommend decisions, verifies in-store work, and sends exceptions to the people who can act.

The risks are visible before approval

Coverage limitation: Nevada and Arizona

Rowantree’s coverage is thin in Nevada and Arizona. We have not assumed a footprint, personnel, facility, or retailer access there. Those states are outside the initial pilot; any later inclusion requires documented coverage verification and a separate written authorization.

Launch-history disclosure

Rowantree’s last two brand launches lost distribution within a year. We do not have a validated causal analysis or a documented recovery result to offer. The response here is prospective: narrow the scope, make readiness and execution evidence visible, inspect leading indicators weekly, and let the founder stop or adjust before a regional rollout.

Retention definition

At each review, retained distribution = activated pilot doors still carrying the approved SKU set / activated pilot doors. Confirmed closures, delistings, or non-carrying doors count as not retained; retailer disposition is recorded, not assumed.

One operating loop around a launch

1 | Opportunity and authorization

Rowantree coordinates retailer requirements and assesses an opportunity. It documents terms and presents any slotting or trade request to Netherfield for written approval before any commitment.

2 | Decision support

Category data informs assortment, introductory pricing, velocity review, replenishment questions, and retention risk. Data, forecasts, and modeled scenarios are not guarantees of sales or distribution.

3 | Field proof and correction

Field activity checks authorized shelf/display execution, captures photo or issue evidence where permitted, reports exceptions, and recommends corrective actions. Recommendations are proposals until accepted.

Important boundary

Slotting support or payment does not buy, secure, or guarantee shelf placement. Retailers retain their own requirements and decisions. Rowantree does not speak for a retailer, waive its requirements, or assure acceptance of Netherfield products.

Category data is not a guarantee of sales or distribution.

Bounded pilot: California-first, six weeks

Scope is a planning assumption to be confirmed in writing: one approved SKU set, named California doors only, six week

Before activation	Agreed named-door scope; inventory/readiness confirmation; approved external claims; available category/scan data; written budget and approval protocol; retailer terms documented.
Weeks 1-2 | setup	Map requirements, confirm no-cost versus paid actions, capture baseline activated doors, release only approved materials and spend.
Weeks 3-5 | execute & measure	Field checks and exception log; weekly velocity, availability, execution, and retention review; Rowantree recommends timely remedies for Netherfield decision.
Week 6 | gate	Joint review against thresholds; continue to a separately authorized next phase, adjust within scope, or stop. No automatic extension.

Control stays with the brand

Operating ownership

Netherfield	Provides inventory/readiness, approved claims and data; approves trade spend, slotting, retailer-facing commitments, and material corrective actions in writing.
Rowantree	Coordinates requirements, proposes category and merchandising actions, executes only authorized activity, maintains evidence and exception log, measures and reports.
Joint founders / leads	Weekly working review; decision gates and exceptions. Tanneryside Advisory reviews unresolved legal or promotional questions.

Escalation and cadence

Rowantree reports a material KPI miss, retailer issue, execution failure, or unapproved-spend request within one business day to Netherfield’s pilot lead. No external or financial commitment proceeds without written brand approval. Weekly working reviews examine the log; a week-3 checkpoint can pause or adjust execution.

Economics are an editable decision tool

Base scenario: illustrative, six-week, California-first

The linked workbook uses founder-editable assumptions, not actual Netherfield results, Rowantree fees, retailer terms, or commitments. Headline values below reconcile to the Base column of the workbook.

Gross sales	54 activated doors x 6 weeks x 9 units/door/week x $6.50 x 92% retention = $17,438
Trade / slotting reserve	$1,080 | separately approved retailer or promotional spend; no placement is promised
Rowantree charges	$4,020 | $1,500 setup + $1,620 service fee + $900 field execution
Net brand proceeds	$12,338 | gross sales less listed trade spend and Rowantree charges

Decision thresholds used in the workbook

Continue only if retention is at least 85%, coverage feasibility is at least 80%, and no material unapproved commitment exists. Adjust if retention is 70%-84% or feasibility is 60%-79%. Stop below either lower bound or when a material readiness/authorization issue remains unresolved.

The founder decision requested

Authorize a controlled planning pilot

Authorize Rowantree and Netherfield to finalize the named California-door scope, readiness checklist, and Base scenario assumptions for a six-week pilot. This authorization is not approval of retailer terms, slotting, trade spend, or any external commitment. Each requires Netherfield’s written approval first.

Claim and promotion discipline

California trade-promotion and advertising treatment as of 15 February 2025: external promotional, comparative, performance, or outcome claims require a reasonable documented basis, approved wording, and retained approval records before use. This sales proposal is not legal advice. Tanneryside Advisory clears unresolved legal or promotional questions; compliance does not guarantee retailer acceptance or commercial results.

Meeting output: a bounded written authorization, or a clear decision not to proceed.